



COMMUNITY TOOLING GUIDE

eBay Draft Lister Setup & Run Guide

Turn a folder of card photos into ready-to-review eBay draft listings — automatically, using AI. No coding experience required.

What you'll need before you start:

- A Windows PC with Python installed (free — instructions inside)
- An Anthropic (Claude) API key — pay-as-you-go, pennies per card
- A free Cloudinary account (photo hosting for your listings)
- Your card photos: front photo, then back photo, per card

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1 What This Tool Actually Does

This is a Python script that looks at your raw card photos, figures out the front/back pairs, uses Claude (Anthropic's AI) to read each card and identify the player, set, year, parallel, and other details, then builds an eBay-ready CSV file you upload straight into **Seller Hub → Reports → Upload**. It also uploads your photos to free image hosting (Cloudinary) so the listing photos are already attached when the draft shows up.

It runs in two steps:

Step 1 — Rename

Scans your raw photos, matches front/back pairs using AI, and renames them to "Player_Name_front.jpg" / "Player_Name_back.jpg".

Step 2 — List

Reads the renamed photos, pulls out all the card details, uploads the photos, and writes the draft CSV eBay needs.

GOOD TO KNOW

This creates *drafts*, not live listings. Nothing goes live on eBay until you personally open each draft in Seller Hub and hit Publish.

ON PURPOSE: IT DOES NOT PRICE YOUR CARDS

Early versions tried having the AI look up recent sold comps and suggest a price automatically. In practice, card values swing too widely — even within the same set and parallel — for that to be reliably accurate, and a confidently-wrong price is worse than no price. So every card is listed at one flat placeholder price (`DEFAULT_LISTING_PRICE` , \$100 by default) instead. You do the actual pricing yourself per card before publishing — this tool's job is to save you the busywork of typing out titles, descriptions, and photo uploads, not to guess what a card is worth.

2 One-Time Setup

You only need to do this section once per computer.

2.1 Install Python

- 1 Go to `python.org/downloads` and download the latest Python for Windows.
- 2 Run the installer. On the very first screen, **check the box "Add python.exe to PATH"** before clicking Install — this step trips up almost everyone who skips it.

2.2 Install the required packages

Open Command Prompt (search "cmd" in the Start menu) and run:

```
pip install anthropic requests pillow
pip install pillow-heif # only needed if your photos are .HEIC (iPhone)
```

2.3 Get an Anthropic API key

- 1 Create an account at `console.anthropic.com`.
- 2 Go to **Settings → API Keys** and create a new key. Copy it somewhere safe.
- 3 Add a few dollars of credit under **Billing** — this is pay-as-you-go, and a typical card costs a fraction of a cent to a few cents to process.

TREAT THIS LIKE A PASSWORD

Never post your API key in a screenshot, Discord message, or chat. Anyone with it can run up charges on your account. If it's ever exposed, regenerate it immediately from the Console.

2.4 Get a free Cloudinary account

Cloudinary hosts your listing photos so eBay can pull them into the draft.

- 1 Sign up free at `cloudinary.com`.
- 2 From the Dashboard, copy your **Cloud Name**.
- 3 Go to **Settings → Upload**, scroll to Upload Presets, and add a new preset set to **Unsigned**. Copy its name.

2.5 Save your keys as environment variables

Every time you open a new Command Prompt window to run the script, type:

```
set ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=sk-ant-your-key-here
set CLOUDINARY_CLOUD_NAME=your_cloud_name
set CLOUDINARY_UPLOAD_PRESET=your_preset_name
```

DON'T WANT TO RETYPE THESE EVERY TIME?

Use `setx` instead of `set` for each line above (e.g. `setx ANTHROPIC_API_KEY sk-ant-...`). This saves it permanently to your Windows user account — close and reopen Command Prompt afterward for it to take effect.

3 Folder Setup & Making It Yours

Pick a main folder for your card business (e.g. `C:\YourShop` or a shared drive letter). Inside it, create a subfolder named `eBay` — that's where your raw, unsorted photos go before each run.

Personalize the script

Open `ebay_draft_listner.py` in Notepad and find the **CONFIG** section near the top. Update these lines for your own shop:

Setting	What to change it to
<code>SHOP_NAME</code>	Your shop's name — shown in every listing description and on the QC report
<code>EBAY_DIR</code>	The full path to your <code>eBay</code> photo folder
<code>OUTPUT_DIR</code>	Where you want the finished CSV and QC report to be saved
<code>DEFAULT_LISTING_PRICE</code>	Your default placeholder price (still adjust per card afterward)

CATEGORY NOTE

`CATEGORY_ID` is currently set to eBay's Sports Trading Card Singles category, which covers soccer cards. If you're listing something else, search eBay's category list for the right ID and swap it in.

Taking photos

- One photo of the **front**, immediately followed by one of the **back**, per card.
- Keep the order consistent — don't mix a batch of all-fronts-then-all-backs.
- Drop all the photos straight into the `eBay` folder — no manual sorting needed.

IPHONE USERS

Your phone shoots **HEIC** by default, and that works fine here — but it needs `pillow-heif` installed first (Step 2.2), or the script will error on your photos. If you'd rather skip that dependency entirely, switch to plain **JPEG**: Settings → Camera → Formats → "Most Compatible". Every step of the script handles JPEG with zero extra setup.

4 Running It

- 1 Open Command Prompt.
- 2 Set your three keys (Step 2.5) if this is a new window.

- 3 Navigate to your folder:

```
cd "C:\YourShop"
```

- 4 Run the script:

```
python ebay_draft_listener.py
```

Command reference

Command	What it does
<code>python ebay_draft_listener.py</code>	Full run — renames photos, then builds the CSV (most common)
<code>python ebay_draft_listener.py --rename</code>	Only renames/sorts photos, no CSV yet
<code>python ebay_draft_listener.py --list</code>	Only builds the CSV, using photos already renamed
<code>python ebay_draft_listener.py --workers 2</code>	Process 2 cards at a time instead of the default 4 (slower, gentler on your connection)
<code>python ebay_draft_listener.py --fix-broken-photos</code>	Repairs old drafts whose photos show up blank (see Troubleshooting)

LARGE BATCHES TAKE A WHILE — AND GO QUIET

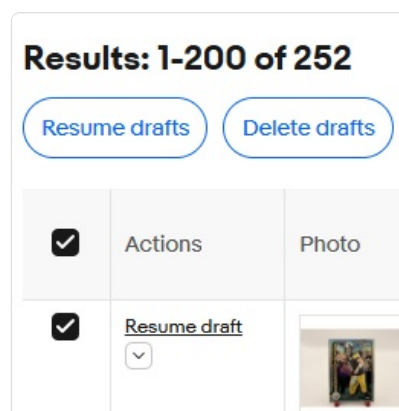
On a big batch, the "Checking images for front/back pairing..." step can sit with no new text for several minutes. That's normal — it's not frozen, it's working through each pair one at a time behind the scenes. Just let it run.

5 After It Runs

When it finishes, you'll have two new files in your output folder:

- **A QC report** (`..._review.html`) — open it in your browser. It shows a thumbnail, title, and price for every card, plus warnings for anything that looks off. Skim this before uploading anything.
- **The draft CSV** (`eBay_Drafts_...csv`) — this is what you upload to eBay.

- 1 Open the QC report and skim for warnings or anything that looks wrong.
- 2 In eBay, go to **Seller Hub → Reports → Upload** and upload the CSV.
- 3 Go to **Listings → Drafts**, check the box at the top to select every new draft, and click **Resume Drafts**. This opens a bulk editor where you can set things the CSV template can't fill in — Package Details, Shipping Policy, Condition, Item Location, Payment Policy, Return Policy, and anything else — for every card at once instead of one at a time. When you're done, save for later.
- 4 Go into each draft individually one more time to **set your real price**, then publish.



Select all, then click "Resume Drafts" to bulk-edit shipping, condition, location, and policies.

ALWAYS SET YOUR OWN PRICE

Every card is listed at the same placeholder price by default. The script doesn't do market research — that part's still on you before you publish.

Two folders also get created next to your `eBay` folder automatically: `Done` (photos for cards that made it into the CSV) and `Needs Review` (cards the AI couldn't confidently fill in — check the QC report for why, fix what's needed, and re-run).

6 Troubleshooting

"ANTHROPIC_API_KEY not set" or "API key is invalid"

You either forgot to run the `set` commands in this Command Prompt window, or opened a fresh window since your last `set`. Environment variables set with `set` only last for that one window — re-run them, or switch to `setx` (Step 2.5) to make them permanent.

"ModuleNotFoundError: No module named '...'"

A required package isn't installed. Re-run the pip install command from Step 2.2.

Photos show up blank/white on the eBay draft

This happens when a photo was uploaded in a format browsers can't display directly (mainly HEIC). Newer versions of this script always convert photos before uploading, so this shouldn't happen going forward — make sure you're on the latest copy of the script. If you have older drafts already affected, run:

```
python ebay_draft_lister.py --fix-broken-photos
```

This rebuilds a small CSV with working photo links for just the affected cards. You'll still need to manually delete the old broken drafts in Seller Hub first, then upload the fix CSV — eBay's CSV format has no way to update a draft that already exists.

Everything's going to "Needs Review"

Open the QC report — every card lists its specific reason (missing player name, unreadable set name, front/back mismatch, etc). Common causes are blurry or badly lit photos, or a very obscure parallel/set the AI genuinely can't identify from the image alone.

It looks stuck / no output for a long time

Normal for big batches — see the callout in Section 4. If it's been well past what feels reasonable and you're worried, it's safe to close the window and re-run; nothing already written to the CSV or moved to `Done` gets touched twice.

7 Questions?

Drop a message in **The Pitch** Discord — happy to help troubleshoot or walk through setup with anyone getting started.